

EVERY SAT GRAMMAR RULE

Category	Rule	Example (Wrong → Right)
Sentence Structure (free points)	A complete sentence = subject + verb + complete thought (use feeling or gut)	"Because I was late." ❌ → "I was late." ✅
	Avoid run-ons	"I ran I tripped." ❌ → "I ran, and I tripped." ✅
	Semicolon joins 2 independent clauses	"I ran; I tripped." ✅
	Comma + FANBOYS joins 2 independent clauses	I ran, and I tripped." ✅
Punctuation(.,")(,:')	Comma = lists, after intro phrases, around extra info	"After school, I went home." ✅
	Colon = list, explanation, or quote (must follow complete sentence) [Misconception: <i>there doesn't need to be list to use a colon</i>]	"I need three things: pencils, paper, and books." ✅
	Semicolon = separates two sentences or complex list (very similar to period). If you see both a period and semicolon cross them out.	"I bought pens, pencils, and erasers; paper, notebooks, and folders." ✅
	Dash = emphasize or replace commas/parentheses (mostly use for extra info)	"She gave me the answer—finally!" ✅
Verbs	Subject-verb agreement (<i>If you see three answer choices with verbs ending in -s, cross them out (since only one should be correct). Likewise, if you see three plural verbs, cross them out.</i>)	"The dogs runs." ❌ → "The dogs run." ✅
	Verb tense consistency	"She runs and ate." ❌ → "She runs and eats." ✅
	Perfect tenses (very rare on SAT)	"I have eaten already." (present perfect)
	Past perfect = before another past event	"I had eaten before she arrived." ✅
Pronouns (he, she, they, I, we, etc.)	Agreement	"Everyone must bring their book." ❌ → "Everyone must bring his or her book." ✅
	Clear reference	"When Sam met Alex, he was late." ❌ (who?)
	Case: subject vs. object	"Me went to the store." ❌ → "I went to the store." ✅

Possession (VERY TRICKY)	Singular = 's (1 subject)	"The dog's bone." ✓
	Plural = s' (2 or more subjects)	"The dogs' toys." ✓
Example of Possession Sat problem	The <u>students homework</u> was scattered all over the classroom floor. A) students homework B) student's homework C) students' homework D) students's homework	Answer C (there more than 1 student owning the homework) A) students homework (missing apostrophe, so no possession) B) student's homework (only talking about 1 student) C) students' homework ✓ D) students's homework (wrong wtf is s's)
	Irregular plural = 's	"The children's toys." ✓
	Its vs. it's (very important) Its = possessive pronoun (it owns something) It's = contraction of "it is," and "it has"	"The cat licked its paw." ✓ / "It's raining." ✓
Modifiers (very long answer choices)	Place modifiers next to what they describe (find the subject)	"Running fast, the finish line was crossed by Sarah." ✗ → "Running fast, Sarah crossed the finish line." ✓
	Adjective vs. adverb	"She runs quick." ✗ → "She runs quickly." ✓
Parallelism (matching)	Items in a list must match	"He likes hiking, swimming, and biking." ✓
	Correlative pairs must match	"Not only... but also" / "Either...or"
Comparisons	Compare like things	"Our score was higher than the other team." ✗ → "Our score was higher than the other team's score." ✓
Idioms & Usage (if speech english natively use your gut)	Correct prepositions	"Interested in" not "interested on"
	Concise phrasing (avoid redundancy) Concise as possible	"She returned back home." ✗ → "She returned home." ✓

Transitions (only tricky ones are included, not every transition word.)	Choose logical connector	"I was tired; however, I finished my work." ✓
	Examples:	But, However, Therefore, Moreover, Nevertheless / Nonetheless, Comma with FANBOYS, Semicolon solo
But	Joins two independent clauses → use comma before , never semicolon	"I wanted to go; but I stayed home." ✗ → "I wanted to go, but I stayed home." ✓
However (this one very tricky)	Joins two independent clauses → use semicolon before, comma after	"I wanted to go, however I stayed home." ✗ → "I wanted to go; however, I stayed home." ✓
Therefore	Same as "however": semicolon before, comma after	"I studied hard, therefore I passed." ✗ → "I studied hard; therefore, I passed." ✓
Moreover	Same as above	"She is smart, moreover she works hard." ✗ → "She is smart; moreover, she works hard." ✓
Nevertheless / Nonetheless	Semicolon before, comma after	"I was tired, nevertheless I finished." ✗ → "I was tired; nevertheless, I finished." ✓
Comma with FANBOYS	Always comma before if joining two independent clauses	"I ran and I tripped." ✗ → "I ran, and I tripped." ✓
Semicolon solo	Joins two independent clauses without a conjunction	"I ran; I tripped." ✓
Confused Words	Their/there/they're	"They're going to their house over there." ✓
	Than vs. then	"She is taller than me. Then we played." ✓
	Affect (verb) vs. Effect (noun)	"The movie affected me." / "The movie had an effect." ✓
Relative Pronouns	Who = subject / whom = object	"The student who studied passed." ✓ / "The person to whom I gave the book..." ✓
	That = essential, which = nonessential	"The car that is red is mine." / "The car, which is red, is mine."
Appositives	Nonessential = commas / essential = no commas (when trying find the main subject try eliminating Nonessential clauses)	"My brother, a doctor, lives in NY." ✓
Word Choice (rare on SAT)	Fewer vs. less	"Fewer cookies" / "Less water" ✓

	Much vs. many	"Much money" / "Many coins" ✓
	Between (2) vs. among (3+)	"Between you and me" / "Among friends" ✓
Adjectives Order (again very rare on SAT)	Opinion → size → age → color → material → noun	Opinion → size → age → color → material → noun
Double Negatives	Avoid	"I don't have no time." ✗ → "I don't have any time." ✓
Verbals (you will see answer choices with to and -ing)	Infinitive = to + verb	"I like to run." ✓
	Gerund = -ing noun	"Running is fun." ✓
	Participle = adjective	"The broken glass cut me." ✓
Tone/Formality	FINALLY SAT=Formal, concise	"Kids these days are kinda lazy." ✗ → "Many students today lack motivation." ✓

THE END